



Star Pitch

After Shah Rukh Khan and Preity Zinta, Shilpa Shetty is putting her post-*Big Brother* millions on the Indian Premier League (IPL). Shetty along with boyfriend Raj Kundra has bought a 12 per cent stake in Rajasthan Royals, the winners of the maiden IPL. "I've always been the underdog, so I identify with this team," said Shetty, who also hinted she might just shimmy for the music video. Last year, Shetty cheered for Vijay Mallya's Royal Challengers but when it came to shopping with \$15 million, she left the liquor baron high and dry. Wonder what Mallya has to say?

Luck by Chance

Since India is the toast of international cinema right now, Lavrenti Lopes is hoping to be the next big Indian thing in Hollywood. Born and brought up in Mumbai, Lopes moved to New York to study at the Lee Strasberg Theatre and Film Institute. The actor has now bagged a role in Leonardo Zelig's *SubHysteria* where 16 people get stuck in a subway in New York. Lopes plays an Indian Muslim who is a computer genius. "When I auditioned, there was no Indian character in the film. But Zelig was happy and decided to adapt one of the characters. It was as if I was creating my own reality," he says. Will he create his own success story too?



"I've always been interested in acting and since the film has a social message, I decided to do it. I play a chief minister who felicitates a doctor treating an AIDS patient." Vijay Wadettiwar, minister of state in Maharashtra Chief Minister Ashok Chavan's team, on his role in the Marathi film, *Aadhar*

YOUNG GUN

In Sanjay Leela Bhansali's *Black*, Ayesha Kapoor left a lasting impression as the young Michelle. But the Puducherry-based actor chose to stay away from films. The 14-year-old is now back with Piyush Jha's *Sikandar*. Set in Kashmir, it's the story of a boy Sikandar and his friend Nasreen, played by Kapoor. The boy's chance discovery of a gun sets in motion a series of events that change everything. "I was looking for a face with a lot of meaning. Ayesha was my first and only choice," says Jha.



The only angle from which to solve a problem is the try-angle.

Har Angle se Mmmmm....

